Y-P-002194(Army-GL)
December 12, 1983

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PINEAPPLE, DICED, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by US Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers diced pineapple in heavy syrup thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The tray pack pineapple shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1).

Type I - Processed from fresh pineapple
Type II - Processed from canned pineapple, Grade A

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8915

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specifications for

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Food Products

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pineapple

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1 and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Pineapple. For type I product, the fruit shall be fresh, clean, sound, properly matured pineapple. For type II product, the canned diced pineapple shall be U.S. Grade A packed in heavy syrup (Brix measurement 18° or more but less than 22°) of the latest season's pack.

3.2.2 Sweetening ingredients. Sweetening ingredients shall be of any one or more safe and suitable nutritive carbohydrate sweeteners, approved by the Food and Drug Administration.

3.2.3 Citric acid. Citric acid shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

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3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Pineapple processing. Pineapples shall be washed, peeled, cored, and diced to conform with Grade A requirements for size and shape as specified in the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pinapples.

3.3.2 Syrup processing. Sweetening ingredients, citric acid and water shall be the only ingredients used in preparation of the heavy syrup.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with prepared, diced pineapples and sufficient syrup, with pH adjusted with citric acid, if necessary, such as to conform to the finished product requirements. The cans shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 15 nor more than 18 inches of mercury immediately after filling.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until the temperature at the center of the can reaches a minimum of 195°F. Records shall be maintained for each lot.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall meet the requirements for canned diced pineapple in heavy syrup (Brix measurement of 18° or more but less than 22°) and shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pineapple. The pH of the finished product shall be a maximum of 4.1. The finished product shall have an average net weight of not less than 106 ounces with no individual can having a net weight of less than 104 ounces or a drained weight of less than 70 ounces.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

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4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or other applicable purchase documents.

4.4.1 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

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4.6.2 Product inspection. The finished product shall be inspected for conformance to the grade, Brix measurement and drained weight requirements in accordance with the provisions of the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Pineapple, and Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain other Processed Food Products. Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.).

4.6.3 pH testing. Three tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The contents of each tray pack shall be blended separately in a Waring blender or equivalent to form three samples. The pH of each sample shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. If the pH of any sample is more than 4.1, the lot shall be rejected.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; (4) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.5 and 3.6. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

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5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width and be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width and be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each package shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. Cans shall show the following statements:

DO NOT HEAT

YIELD

Approximately 25 servings of 1/2 cup (4 ounces) each.

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5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR
MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of product required (see 1.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
e. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for inspection, selection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-A773

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
Y-P-002194(Army-GL)	Pineapple, Diced, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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